OVELISTIC SCREENPLAY

POKÉMON NOCTURNE

EPISODE 02

The Prisoner of the Locked World

Author

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Working compilation

Status · compiled draft · P1 notices open · EN-GB apparatus

Format	Novelistic screenplay · EN anchors
Target duration	To be set — corpus ≈ 80 min read aloud
Scenes	21
Version	2026-09-23 · EN-GB dossier after P1

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Episode sheet

Series Pokémon Nocturne

Episode 02 — The Prisoner of the Locked World

Author Adelbert Vervloet

Logline

From the roads of Kanto to the League arena, Red meets minute sages and a rival locked in a perfect monopoly. He beats Green without elation. Oak names the Coyote. On Route 22, Giovanni leaves a son on his knees.

Place in the arc

Due: minute generosity versus Green's malice; elective trauma; the Dex as arrogance; evolution refused (Pikachu / Growlithe / Bellsprout); locked world; pragmatic respect; costly victory; Coyote; Silver / Giovanni.

Paid: Red contains Green without proclaiming himself a brother; Charizard pays for Blaze; Oak does not congratulate.

Open: the Coyote is real; Green's tears unabsorbed; badge the colour of Green; the boy on his knees.

Characters — this episode only

Name	Function here
Red	Recognises the weak; contains without a fraternal sermon
Green	Prisoner of the closed world; toxic diligence; Dex
Blue	Blinding closeness; "Don't forget Water"
Oak	Contrition; names the Coyote
Lance	Icy witness at the League
Hiker / Gentleman	Minute wisdom; evolution refused
Giovanni	Desertion on Route 22
Red-haired boy	Unnamed in the text (Silver) — to be anchored

Places (EN anchors)

Mt. Moon · Route 24 · Pokémon Tower / café · Celadon Library · Route 15 · Cinnabar · Silph Co. · League · Route 22.

What the episode refuses to explain

What Green really buried. Whether Blue loves Red. The visible nature of the Coyote. The name of the boy on his knees.

Motifs to hold

Malice that enters through battle · trauma as a selective alibi · the Dex that humiliates · evolution = volatility · inherited technocracy · to contain ≠ to save · victory without honour · the Coyote as witness.

Technical notes — outside the scenes

Rule: any mechanical instruction (ability, PP, status, "activate / do not activate") leaves the scene body. It lives here. The text says only what is seen and what is paid.

Scene	Note (do not paste into the narrative)
Costly battle	Activate Blaze (Charizard). Do not activate Torrent (Blastoise). Rain Dance then Fire Spin make a second rain impossible for the moment. Reference: Julia Belmont vs Olrox EP01 S01 Castlevania Nocturne
Same	Final Hydro Pump: Charizard exposes himself on purpose to trip Blaze's threshold, then Blast Burn.
Arrogance	Bellsprout Lv. 29, unevolved — a figure read on the Dex, not spoken aloud.

In a publishable / DeepL edition: these lines stay on the sheet. In the narrative, keep the flame that whitens, the wounded wing, the silence of indebtedness — not the ability's name.

BGM index — pieces

Scene	Piece	Span
Malice… / flashbacks	Could Not Be Caged	00:00–00:34 · 01:17– · 01:55 –end
Flashback Green / Miniskirt	Powerful Predatory Deadly	02:10–02:20 (+ reprises 01:21 / 02:05 / 03:08)
Toxic dedication	Black Eyes	01:36–
Mundane bliss	Don't Leave Me	02:18–02:37 (optional)
Incubi / courage	Fire It Is	01:40–end
Water, flame, world	Maria Renard	01:14–end
Fate / prisoner	Vampire Messiah · Dido's Lament	00:00–00:44 · Lament +

		01:21–end
Respect / battle / void	Don’t Listen to Her	01:04 → 04:21 (by stages)
Victory divorced	Somewhere Safe	→ 01:14–end
Various	My Sister · Rebellion · Lacrimosa (Édouard)	see the scenes concerned

BGM index — traces

Episode fragments, not titles. Form: Trace · EP… S… span.

Scene	Trace
Minute generosity	Trace · EP04 S02 20:40–22:00 (+ 00:50–01:09 in the fragment)
Elective trauma	Trace · EP05 S01 07:32–08:22 → Trace · EP03 S01 16:54–17:29
Arrogance	Trace · EP04 S02 18:10–19:00
Mundane bliss	Trace · EP05 S02 03:10 (fade)
Silph ideology / sequels	Trace · EP05 S02 04:40–06:02 · EP01 S02 25:50–27:00 · EP04 S01 18:10–18:47
Paradoxical encouragement	Trace · EP06 S02 00:30–01:50
Route 22	Trace · EP03 S01 23:04–24:17

Order of scenes

1. Minute Generosity
2. Malice Outranks Defeat
3. Elective Trauma
4. Toxic Dedication
5. Arrogance Tinged with Ignorance
6. The Luxury of Mundane Bliss
7. Pathological Ideology (Silph Co.)
8. The Outdated Dogma
9. The Starters Dictate Fate
10. Humiliating Responsibilities
11. The Simple Dream as a Trainer

12. The Incubus Made Concrete
13. The Extinction of Courage
14. Paradoxical Encouragement
15. Water, Flame, the World
16. The Fate of Being the Strongest
17. The Prisoner of the Locked World
18. Pragmatic Respect
19. The Costly and Hollow Battle
20. Victory Divorced from Elation
21. Route 22

The scenes are inserted here. The close follows the body.

Opening scene – A tiny act of generosity

Mt. Moon

The tunnel at Mt. Moon was cold and stifling. The air was stagnant, heavy with a mineral-like dampness and the smell of wet stone. Red struggled to make his way forward, his body still bearing the marks of his battle with Raticate. He stumbled occasionally over the uneven stones, breathing heavily. He had recalled Charmander earlier, for fear of overburdening him. Even though he had ultimately defused the threat, Team Rocket's henchmen would probably not have shown the same restraint.

At his side, the Hiker walked with a steady stride, almost unflappable. Ahead of them, the ground bulged slightly in places: Diglett was burrowing and guiding their progress with instinctive precision, as if it could read the fissures in the rock better than any map. The little Pokémon wasn't looking for a fight. It was simply clearing a safe path, with a kind of animal wisdom—silent and efficient.

Red stumbled again. The Hiker immediately held out his arm to him, without a single unnecessary word. His hand was calloused and strong. There was neither pity nor condescension in the gesture, only practical help.

BGM 'EP04 S02 20:40–22:00'

They were approaching the exit. A diffuse grey glow was beginning to filter through at the end of the tunnel. The Hiker finally broke the silence, in a low, matter-of-fact voice, almost as if he were speaking to himself:

'I'm not really keeping it for battle…'

He paused briefly, his eyes fixed on Diglett's back as it continued to move forward.

"He saved my life once. I'd got myself into a tight spot, out in the wilderness. He gave me a hand. Since then, he's agreed to stay. He lends his natural wisdom to those who need it whilst travelling. That's all."

Red did not reply. He was too weary to find the right words, and too modest to attempt to voice them. He simply listened, in silence.

At last they stepped out into the open.

Daylight enveloped them all at once. The fresh air, laden with the scents of damp earth, grass and wild flowers, washed over their faces. Red blinked, as if rediscovering a forgotten sensation. A light breeze gently lifted the hems of his jacket. Behind them, the darkness of the mountain already seemed far away. Ahead, the landscape opened out onto hills bathed in light, with the first outlines of Cerulean City visible in the distance.

The Hiker paused on the threshold, Diglett at his feet. He glanced at Red from the corner of his eye, without pressing the matter.

"It takes pride in helping those who fight to protect us from evil," he said simply. "Even when they don't have the means to do so by the book."

BGM "EP04 S02 20:40–22:00" 00:50–01:09

It was not a direct compliment. Just a calm, almost detached remark. But Red understood what it was implying. He lowered his head slightly, feeling awkward. He did not like being spoken of in that way, even when it was said matter-of-factly. Yet something inside him relaxed a little. His commitment to fighting the henchmen had not been entirely in vain. There had been some sort of reward, however modest.

He looked up towards the open countryside. The landscape seemed vaster, more alive to him than it had felt for a long time. The wind, the smells, the light… all of it gave him the impression that he had been through something greater than mere combat. He remained silent, gazing thoughtfully at the path leading down towards the town.

The Hiker made no attempt to say anything more. He resumed his walk at a leisurely pace, with Diglett quietly digging ahead of them to make the path safer.

Red followed them without a word.

End of scene

Scene – Malice that is worse than defeat

Route 24

BGM 'Could Not be Caged' 00:00–00:34

By the side of Route 24, a young girl was kneeling in the grass. She was clutching her Nidoran♀ close to her, her face buried in its fur. Her shoulders shook in fits and starts. She was crying silently, but her tears fell onto the Pokémon's coat; it looked just as exhausted as she did.

A little further on, near a tree, Red and Camp Boy watched the scene without approaching. The boy in the green outfit stood with his arms crossed, looking uncomfortable. Red, for his part, remained silent, his body still bearing the marks of fatigue from his own battles. A light breeze rustled the tall grass around them.

Camp Boy finally spoke, in a low voice, almost as if he were justifying himself:

'…What were we doing? *Shouldn't we go over to her?*'

Red did not answer straight away. He was looking at the girl. He could see clearly that she was not just crying because she had lost a fight. There was something heavier, something stickier in her distress.

Camp Boy turned slightly towards him.

"What do you think, Red? Why are these tears so… contaminating?"

Red lowered his eyes for a moment. When he spoke, his voice was low and hesitant, as if he were searching for the right words as he spoke them.

"She's crying… not because she lost."

He paused briefly. The wind rustled the leaves above them.

Flashback

BGM ‘Powerful Predatory Deadly’ 02:10–02:20

The battle was already well underway. Wartortle was facing off against Nidoran♀. Green, standing back, was giving his orders in a calm yet urgent voice. Every attack seemed calculated to inflict maximum damage in the shortest possible time. Wartortle obeyed, but one could sense that it, too, was being swept up by something greater than itself — as if its trainer’s obsession had eroded some of its restraint. The blows were precise, almost brutal in their effectiveness. There was no pleasure in inflicting pain. Only a mechanical determination to dominate as quickly as possible.

On the other side, Miniskirt watched her Pokémon take the blows. Her expression had already changed. It was no longer just the tension of a battle. There was already, in her eyes, the confused feeling that something more important than victory was being taken from her. Wartortle’s final attack was particularly brutal.

Back to the present

BGM ‘Could Not be Caged’ 01:17–

Red raised his head slightly. His voice was still just as low, but a little firmer.

‘She’s hurt… because something has entered her. Through the fight. A… malevolence.’

Camp Boy said nothing. He stood there, his arms still crossed, his gaze fixed on Miniskirt. His confusion was plain to see: he clearly did not know what to make of this answer. He simply watched the girl, who was now crying a little harder, still clutching her Pokémon close to her.

Red said nothing more either. He looked weary. He knew he’d hit upon something true, but words remained inadequate.

Flashback 2 (very short)

BGM ‘Could Not be Caged’ 01:55–end

Green was standing there after the battle had ended. He looked at Miniskirt, who was crying, a slightly embarrassed expression on his face. He seemed to understand, vaguely, that things had gone too far. But he said nothing.

Back on Route 24, Red and Camp Boy had not stirred. Miniskirt still wept softly, her face hidden against her Nidoran♀. The wind continued to rustle the grass around them. Neither boy ventured closer; they stood helpless, as if some terrible thing had occurred and they did not know how to make it right.

Red lowered his head slightly, lost in thought.

End of scene

Scene — The Elective Trauma

The Pokémon Tower

Opening BGM 'EP05 S01 07:32–08:22'

Dust hung suspended in the faint, yellow light of the Pokémon Tower. No sound of ghostly footsteps. No breath from Gastly. The air was still, almost too dry. Green stood before a row of graves, his body slightly bent forward. He wasn't reading the inscriptions. He was simply staring, for a long time, as if something behind the stone had stopped responding.

Red had been there for a while, standing back, partially hidden by the corner of a pillar. Green hadn't noticed him.

Café / Lingerie

The sound of a cup being set down on a saucer brought Red back to the present.

They were sitting in a small, ordinary café by a window. Outside, the daylight was unremarkable. Distant conversations, the rustle of fabric, a customer passing by. Nothing hostile. Yet the atmosphere between them seemed heavier than it ought to have been.

Blue hadn't touched her drink. She was staring at a vague spot on the table.

'Have you noticed any changes in Green, Red…?'

Red looked up slightly.

"What do you mean…?"

Blue hesitated. Her voice remained low.

"He gives the impression of not quite being the same anymore… since his visit to the Pokémon Tower. That's my view, anyway."

Red did not reply straight away; he let the silence settle.

Blue continued, more cautiously:

"According to the rumours… he was there to bury his Raticate. We don't really know which version is true. But we haven't seen that Raticate since…"

Red slowly turned his gaze towards her.

"…Do you really believe that story…?"

Blue clenched her fingers slightly around her cup:

"Don't you think that such distress could completely transform someone…?"

Her question was not a defence; she truly seemed to be seeking an answer.

Red tilted his head ever so slightly.

“Yes. I don’t dispute that.”

He paused. When he spoke again, his voice remained calm, but there was an unintentional firmness to it.

“But if the others were to take the same approach as Green… would you treat them fairly…?”

Blue looked up. For a moment, she seemed taken aback. She hadn’t anticipated the conversation taking this turn.

She lowered her gaze again. Her shoulders slumped slightly.

“…I hadn’t really wanted to look at things that way.”

Her voice had grown quieter.

“It just happened… without me realising it,” she said. “As if it had already been decided before I even thought about it.”

BGM: transition to ‘EP03 S01 16:54–17:29’

She looked away towards the window.

“It wasn’t… what I wanted to do.”
She did not ask for forgiveness outright. Rather, it seemed that, at the very moment she spoke, she realised she had adopted an attitude she had not consciously chosen.

Red did not press his advantage. He looked away towards the window.

“In many stories… someone like him goes through a trauma, and that’s enough to explain everything else.”

He paused for a moment, as if weighing his own words.

“But when it’s others… less visible, less well-off… we always find a reason not to look for so long. Trauma as a biased and selective alibi… for the privileged…”

Blue said nothing. She understood where he was going with this, and it made her feel uncomfortable.

After a moment, she murmured:

“My closeness to him sometimes prevents me from seeing him clearly. And it blinds me at times.”

Red remained silent for a little while longer. Then he said, almost to himself:

‘Green can’t just fall apart over something so trivial. Even if I remain neutral… it’s also a way of not letting his reputation crumble too quickly.’

Blue looked at him askance. A hint of weary teasing crept into her voice.

“Are you doing it for Professor Oak as well…?”

Red did not smile.

“…Perhaps.”

He paused one last time.

“Your relationship with him is blinding you. But without a connection like that… or without the Professor… I probably wouldn’t have any reason strong enough to bother with it. Without ending up crushed.”

Blue said nothing more. She had heard the boundary Red had just drawn, and she had nothing to say in response.

Final flashback: the Pokémon Tower

Inside the Tower, Green finally looked up.

He had finally noticed Red’s presence.

Their eyes met.

Green’s eyes were hollow. It was impossible to tell whether they still held the grief of something external, or whether a part of him had already ceased to respond.

He said nothing.

Dust continued to float in the yellow light.

End of scene

Scene — The Toxic Dedication

Celadon Municipal Library

The library smelled of warm paper and polished wood. A neutral light streamed in through the tall windows. Someone was tidying books at the back of the room. A chair creaked faintly. Nothing else.

Red had stopped between two bookshelves.

Green was sitting at a table, slightly apart but not isolated. Around him, civilians were working or reading without paying him any attention. He had opened a laptop, with several folders lined up to his right and a notebook to his left. His movements were precise and steady. He turned a page, made a note, returned to the screen, without any apparent haste or slowness.

From a distance, you might have thought he was simply very studious.

Red did not approach. He watched.

Gradually, certain details became clearer.

BGM: ‘Black Eyes’ (from 01:36)

The nape of Green’s neck remained too still. His shoulders never relaxed. When he picked up a document, his fingers handled it with an almost mechanical efficiency, without those little, unnecessary hesitations one usually has. His face was calm, but a calmness devoid of breath. He

didn’t even hint at a half-smile, nor did he show any micro-expression of fatigue or impatience. He was entirely absorbed in the task.

The diligence was genuine. On the surface, it even had something admirable about it. Yet something already seemed too rigid. Too focused. As if the effort no longer had any connection to the outside world.

Red felt a vague unease rising within him, still taking shape. Not an accusation. Rather, a muffled question: if he carried on like this for much longer… where might it lead him?

Green turned his head slightly.

His gaze found Red without hesitation. There was no overt surprise, no embarrassment, no particular warmth. Only a clear, composed, almost ordinary recognition. He looked at him for a second, his face serene.

Then he turned his head away and went back to work exactly as before.

The same rhythm. The same precision. As if the interruption had never happened.

Red stood motionless for a moment.

The relief was immediate, but incomplete. Beneath Green’s calm exterior, something still felt too tense. A lingering anxiety set in, subtle yet persistent.

Red eventually walked away.

Behind him, Green carried on writing.

End of scene

Scene — Arrogance tinged with ignorance

Route 15

BGM ‘EP04 S02 18:10–19:00’

There was hardly any wind. The tall grass barely stirred. In the distance, the irregular rumble of a vehicle passing on the road could be heard.

The battle had already begun.

The Picnicker cradled her empty Poké Ball, her shoulders drawn up with eager anticipation. Bellsprout stood before her, stem slightly bent, leaves motionless. She had issued the challenge without a hint of suspicion, almost casually.

Green watched her for a second longer than necessary.

In this area, tamed Pokémon were generally of a higher level. A Bellsprout at this stage seemed out of place. This gave rise to a distinct, almost immediate scepticism within him.

He took out his Pokédex.

The movement was calm, almost inconsequential, like a simple check. Just curiosity. The screen lit up with a cold glow. The data appeared.

Bellsprout. Level 29.

Green said nothing. His gaze lingered a moment too long on the characters. A very slight tension flashed across his jaw. No grimace. No comment. Just something closing off, too quickly, behind his eyes.

He didn't really understand.

At this level, not letting a Pokémon evolve was, to him, a form of madness. A trainer who took their training seriously could not afford to do that. The idea that one might deliberately sacrifice potential in order to maintain a more stable, more docile, more manageable relationship on a day-to-day basis did not cross his mind clearly. It remained beyond his grasp.

The Picnicker had seen the device. She did not fully grasp its purpose, but she had seen the shift. Green's face had scarcely moved, and yet something had receded. An only half-controlled air of disdain hung between them.

She clutched the empty Poké Ball a little tighter against her stomach. The battle no longer felt the same. The initial enthusiasm had vanished in an instant, leaving a dull sense of humiliation that was hard to put into words. She already regretted having proposed this battle. But it was too late to back out. There was no going back. All she could do was see it through. Her shoulders slumped slightly, leaving her with a heavy, unmoving sense of unease.

Green closed the Pokédex and slipped it into his pocket. He tried to resume a neutral, almost impassive expression, as if nothing had happened. The gesture was correct. But it remained a little too precise, a little too self-conscious.

The girl was no longer looking at him. She was staring at Bellsprout, her lips pressed together, her thoughts already elsewhere.

The wind stirred the grass around them ever so slightly.

End of scene

Scene — The luxury of mundane bliss

Cinnabar Island

Twilight was slowly settling over Cinnabar. The heat from the volcanic ground still rose, mingling with the scent of salt. In the distance, the sound of the surf could be heard, steady and almost indifferent.

Red held the Thunderstone in the palm of his hand. He examined it cautiously, without any obvious intention. The stone was cold despite the surrounding heat. Beside him, Pikachu remained silent, its ears turned slightly towards him.

The Gentleman sat a little way off, his walking stick resting against his knee. Growlithe lay near his feet, its muzzle resting on its paws, its eyes half-closed.

After a moment, the old man spoke in a measured voice:

BGM ‘EP05 S02 03:10’

“Why does your Pikachu remain unevolved, if it’s so strong… if I may ask?”

Red did not reply straight away. He looked at the stone, then at Pikachu.

“It’s ambiguous.”

He paused.

“I needed his support back then. But fate seems to have bound me to him.”

His voice remained low, almost cautious.

“Usually, my Pokémon would have evolved. Pikachu is the only one whose situation is more unusual… or rather, dictated.”

He glanced briefly at Growlithe, without pressing the point.

“I’ve come across Trainers whose Pokémon hadn’t evolved, even at a high level. They could have evolved. My Pikachu gives me a glimpse into their reasons… and reinforces our bond.”

He then looked up at the Gentleman.

“For now, I’ll put the same question back to you. Even though yours seems to have become quite strong. Why…?”

The Gentleman fell silent for a moment, weighing his words with care, yet without evading the question.

“Unlike professional Trainers, for us ordinary folk… evolution isn’t just a boost. It brings uncertainty.”

He placed a distracted hand on Growlithe’s head.

“It’s not just a question of cost, food or time. Temperaments change. Behaviour becomes less predictable. Everything becomes irreversible. You can no longer really be sure that it’s still the same one that’s been with us. More unmanageable, sometimes.”

He continued, in a lower voice:

“If Pokémon agree to stay with humans simply to become stronger, then perhaps our refusal would reveal our selfishness. We simply wouldn’t want to lose that relationship. Even if it means refusing to grow up.”

“Even by rejecting this evolution, we simply want to live life on our own terms. And we can grow that way… I hope.”

BGM ‘EP05 S02 03:10’ — fade / gradual out

Red listened to him without interruption. A very faint smile, devoid of irony, flitted across his face. Nothing but gratitude.

‘Personal fulfilment isn’t just about the physical or the body… There are other ways to improve oneself. That’s what I learnt on my journey.’

Optional background music: ‘Don’t Leave Me’ 02:18 — subtle introduction

He looked down at Pikachu for a moment.

“Even as we gradually grow stronger, we never lose sight of that simple dream: to stay with those we love. Even if that might be selfish.”

BGM ‘Don’t Leave Me’ — fades out around 02:37

The Gentleman tilted his head slightly. A subtle hint of gratitude flashed in his eyes, almost a silent agreement.

Pikachu did not stir. Neither did Growlithe.

All around them, the light continued to dim. No one really knew whether Red was talking only about the Pokémon, or about something else entirely.

End of scene

Scene — The Pathological Ideology

Silph Co., near the director’s office

BGM ‘EP05 S02 04:40–06:02’

The air was heavy. It smelled of burning, of heated metal, and of something more indefinable — a tension that had not yet found a place to settle. The neon lights on the ceiling cast a pale, slightly dingy glow.

Red was bent over his Pokémon. He was tending to them with precise, slightly too rapid movements, as if he wanted to get it over with. Charizard was still breathing heavily beside him, its wings half-folded.

Green stood a little way off, arms by his sides. He didn’t seem in any hurry to leave. Nor was he really determined to stay.

Red spoke without looking up.

‘Say… why are you just standing there…?’

Green replied in a neutral, almost nonchalant tone:

“Me? To train. That’s it.”

Red froze. His fingers hovered for a moment over a wound. Then he slowly looked up.

“You’re calling fighting a mafia gang just training? Or a game…?”

His voice wasn’t loud. Just tense, incredulous.

“There are hostages. Civilians. Oppressed people. None of that matters to you… in the face of your power?”

Green looked away slightly. A genuine hesitation flitted across his face. He searched for the right words, and what he came up with sounded false even before he’d spoken them.

“I don’t think like that. It’s simply… a lower priority. From my perspective.”

The silence that followed was heavier than the words.

Red stared at him for a moment longer. Then he asked, in a lower voice:

“If you’ve come because their leader is here… and he’s serving as your sparring partner… will you help me defeat him?”

Green did not reply straight away. When he finally spoke, there was something too contrived, almost defensive, about his voice.

“No. You’re the one who won. I’ll leave that chance to whoever prioritises saving the world more.”

The words hung between them, sounding forced. For a moment, he himself seemed surprised to have phrased it that way.

Red looked at him. You could see the anger rising, clear, almost physical. He opened his mouth slightly, on the verge of speaking, of calling him out, of no longer holding back what he was thinking.

Then something shifted within him. Weariness, perhaps. Or urgency. Or the simple realisation that lingering here would change nothing.

He straightened up. With a swift gesture, he recalled Charizard. The light from the Poké Ball swallowed the dragon’s silhouette, then faded.

Without another word, Red headed for the door of the headmaster’s office.

Green stood motionless. His expression was hard to read: a murky mixture of relief, stifled shame, and something else still — something that resembled a desertion he was only half-willing to admit.

The door closed behind Red.

Green did not move.

End of scene

Scene — The Outdated Dogma

Professor Oak’s Laboratory

BGM: ‘EP01 S02 25:50–27:00’

Evening had well and truly set in. In the laboratory, the lights remained steady, too pristine. An orderly silence reigned amongst the shelves and the switched-off equipment, as if the place were striving to maintain a semblance of normality.

Professor Oak regarded Green with restrained gravity.

‘I don’t recall entrusting you with these missions so that you could compete with me like this.’

His tone was lecturing, yet already tinged with weariness.

Green did not flinch. His voice remained calm, almost reasonable.

“That’s not it.”

He paused briefly, then continued in a lower voice:

‘I’m not particularly keen on defeating Red. But if I can’t… I feel as though I’m straying from my ultimate goal.’

His fingers clenched briefly around his sleeve.

‘I need to know what I’m lacking in order to achieve it.’

Oak looked away for a moment, as if searching for the right words.

‘When I was still a Trainer, I wasn’t so obsessed with power, despite my results.’

He turned back to Green.

“Power comes with responsibilities.”

Green tilted his head slightly. His reply was patient, almost conciliatory, but one could sense a hint of weariness with the phrase.

“I know.”

A silence.

“But those who possess power… generally don’t fulfil them. Since it’s not really compulsory… is it?”

Oak showed no sign of surprise. Only a heavier silence. As if he recognised the flaw, yet was unable — or unwilling — to address it.

He sighed quietly. When he spoke again, his voice was more hesitant, almost reluctant.

‘…As such… you wouldn’t be surprised if I told you that you didn’t win because you don’t love your Pokémon enough…’

The sentence hung in the still air of the laboratory. A moral, somewhat saccharine, already worn-out one. He himself seemed to believe it only half-heartedly.

Green did not argue. Nor did he smile. He simply looked at Oak, his expression hard to read, like someone who had already realised that this response was getting nowhere.

Silence settled once more.

No real retort. No resolution.

Just that overly orderly calm, and something unresolved that hung between them.

End of scene

Scene — The starters dictate the outcome

Blue's house

Evening had well and truly set in. Red held the cup of rooibos with milk that Blue had made for him. She herself had barely touched hers. She simply held it against her palms, as if to ground herself.

Outside, the wind barely stirred the leaves.

Red took a sip.

'So… I've done what you asked me to. I'm keeping an eye on Green. I'm holding him back as much as I can.'

Blue tilted her head slightly.

"Thank you."

She finally raised the cup to her lips, took a very small sip, then set it down again.

"I can't guarantee anything," added Red. "Even I haven't always beaten him."

"I know. That's already a lot."

Silence fell. Blue stared at the bottom of her cup.

"Why me?" asked Red after a moment. "You've known him all your life. Much longer than I have."

Blue didn't answer straight away. His fingers slowly traced the porcelain.

"Sometimes… the longer you've known someone, the less you really see them."

Red looked up, slightly taken aback.

"You're exaggerating. In many ways, you know him better than anyone."

Blue shook her head slightly.

"Exactly. It's made me blind to certain aspects. I ended up getting used to it. To no longer questioning things. And now… I realise I've let too many things slip by."

She sighed, almost silently.

"It's… humiliating."

Red remained silent for a moment, watching her profile.

"He pushed you aside," he observed. "By focusing solely on his goal."

Blue nodded.

"Yes. And he knew it was getting to me. But he chose anyway."

Red lowered his voice slightly.

“Take care of yourself. You have invested so much of yourself in this… Even though I do not know why you care so much about him.”

The remark had come out too bluntly, almost awkwardly. Blue heard it. A slight unease flitted across her face, but she wasn’t offended. She realised he’d spoken without any ulterior motive.

She looked up at him.

BGM: ‘Lacrimosa’ by Mozart, Edouard’s version in *Nocturne* EP06 S01 14:20-16:37

‘If I’d been able to choose Squirtle… I don’t think I would have cared for him quite so much.’

Red froze.

Tears had already begun to roll down Blue’s cheeks. She didn’t wipe them away. She didn’t even close her eyes. She simply let them fall, her gaze slightly lost.

Red understood. All too clearly. He didn’t know where to put himself.

Blue saw it straight away.

“Don’t get me wrong,” she said in a low voice. “I’m glad it’s Misty.”

Red could not reply straight away.

“For a long time, I thought that without Squirtle… I wouldn’t really belong by anyone’s side anymore. Misty took that place. And she filled it better than I ever did. Really. I was just afraid… of no longer being of any use.”

Red looked away slightly. Strangely, some of the tension within him eased.

Blue continued, more calmly, despite her tears.

“People look at your relationship and forget that you’re not from the same town. It’s more complicated than it seems. You’re managing to hold your own. Me… I’m not so sure about Green. Because I’ve stayed too close.”

Red frowned slightly.

“You’re talking as if leaving your town is necessarily dangerous.”

Blue shook her head.

“No. But we idealise what comes from outside too much. We forget the cost. And we also forget the value of the bonds we have here. Even between two neighbouring towns. Those bonds are fragile. They require patience. Not everyone is cut out to go far away like you. Me… if I’d left later, I’d probably have lost my way. So I accept it.”

Red looked at her for a long time.

“And Green… aren’t you being a bit too selfless with him?”

Blue gave a very slight nod, almost a joyless smile.

“I’ve already considered every possible scenario where things might have turned out differently. It leads nowhere. Even if it’s hard to achieve. It might not be the best fate for us. But it’s… the fairest. He shouldn’t end up alone.”

She fell silent for a moment. The tears returned, more heavily.

“There’s still some good left in him. Even if it’s only a little. It might not be what we would have wanted… but it’s what’s fairest. He shouldn’t end up alone.”

Her voice faltered slightly.

“I’m sorry,” she murmured. “I have no regrets. But… growing up with this is hard.”

Red waited for the silence to settle.

“Do you still want me to challenge him in the League… if it ever comes to that?”

Blue drew a slow breath.

“Yes. If that is the only way to set him free. But I am not forcing you. It is up to you to decide whether he still deserves to be set free.”

Red stared at her.

“You’re asking me because that’s what you really want, aren’t you?”

Blue looked away slightly. His voice became almost inaudible.

“…Because I don’t want you to be sacrificed in all this. And because I want you to stay happy. In the end.”

Red did not reply.

There was nothing left to clarify between them. Only what hung in the air, and the tears that Blue was no longer even trying to hold back.

The room fell silent once more.

End of BGM “*EP04 S01 18:10–18:47*”

End of scene

Scene – Humiliating Responsibilities

Route 22

Twilight was already settling over Route 22. The light had turned a dirty ochre, skimming the ground and lengthening the shadows. The air smelled of warm dust and crushed grass.

Charizard held his ground, wings half-spread, panting. Battle scars still streaked his flanks.

Green recalled his Pokémon without a word. The light from the Poké Ball faded. A second later, another one opened.

Blastoise appeared, moving heavily. Its feet sank into the dry earth. The cannons on its shell raised themselves with a dull clang of metal. It did not roar. It merely stared at Charizard.

Red did not move.

Charizard, for his part, shrugged his shoulders. Tension built in his wings. He was about to take off, but the movement remained incomplete, as if held back from within. His claws scraped the ground without moving forward.

BGM: 'Vampire Messiah' 00:45–01:17

Red could feel the warmth of his Pokémon's body right through to the palm of his hand clutching the Poké Ball. He looked at Blastoise, then at Charizard. The decision was swift, almost brutal. It wasn't just a question of type. Nor was it simply the reluctance of a first partner. It was something else: the all-too-clear temptation to turn it into a battle for prestige, a settling of scores between starters. And the price that would follow.

His fingers tightened.

The red light enveloped Charizard before it could even protest. The space it had occupied was suddenly emptied. All that remained was the dust hanging in the air and Red's slightly too heavy breath.

Opposite him, Green had not moved. His face remained neutral, almost mechanical, pale in the low light. No visible mockery. No explicit contempt. Just that impassivity which, in the silence, weighed heavier than an accusation.

Red lowered his gaze slightly towards his remaining Poké Balls. He already knew what this recall would cost him. Not just in this battle. Beyond it.

He grabbed another Poké Ball.

The air had grown thicker.

End of scene

Scene – The simple dream of a Trainer

Red's bedroom

The home computer screen cast a bluish, slightly dingy light into Red's bedroom. Outside, night had already fallen. You could hear almost nothing, apart from the faint hum of the machine.

Misty appeared on the screen, sitting with her body leaning slightly forward, her arms crossed on the table.

"Yes," said Red. "I beat Green. But next time… I'm not so sure."

Misty raised an eyebrow. A very faint smile tugged at the corner of her mouth.

"Is that the look a winner's supposed to have…?"

BGM 'My Sister' – 00:28

Red did not notice the teasing; his gaze was fixed on a point just beyond the camera.

"It's not really about winning this time. It's the League."

He paused, searching for the right words.

“Overall… I’ve managed to keep him at bay so far. But that’s no longer enough to tip the balance. He’s becoming more… organised. His Pokémon are better prepared. He’s using more advanced TMs. I’m not sure if my approach will hold out much longer. Apparently… only a battle at the League could still prove him wrong.”

Misty did not reply straight away. She watched him through the screen, sifting through what he was saying, letting the non-essential details slip by.

“So my hunch back then was right,” she finally said. “It wasn’t me who would become the real obstacle.”

Red nodded slightly.

“Yes. Thank you for being so thorough just now. Really. I’m grateful to you.”

Misty tilted her head slightly.

“Should I take that as a thank you… or a compliment?”

“Both.”

He did not attempt to explain himself further. Silence fell. Then his voice dropped again.

“You were the one who got me out of trouble when I was at my most lost. Without you… I don’t know how I would have coped. I owe you one, Misty. Sorry for all that nonsense.”

Misty looked away for a moment. A fleeting shadow of joy, too vague to put into words, flitted across her face. She let it pass.

“You’ve overcome so much,” she said next, in a more serious tone. “And now you’re backing out? What’s going on? Do you lack confidence that much?”

Red shook his head.

“No. It’s not that.”

He searched for his words a little longer this time.

“It’s more… what comes next. Who I’m going to become. If I stop Green from winning the title… that means I won’t be allowed to lose anymore. There’ll be no turning back. You taught me that losing is part of life. That it can even bring us closer to others. This decision… it feels like I’m betraying that.”

Misty remained silent. There was a slight hardening in her expression.

“And anyway,” Red continued, “if the strongest end up like Giovanni… does it really make much difference, even if I beat Green? I’m scared. Not just of others. Perhaps of myself, too.”

He lowered his gaze slightly.

“It’s irreversible. Like Pokémon evolution. There are Trainers who refuse to let theirs evolve, just to keep things simpler. Deep down… I had the same sort of dream. Even if it’s selfish. Or immature. I realised I wasn’t really aiming for the League. I even considered not going. But that choice… doesn’t sit right with me either.”

Misty did not reply straight away; she seemed to be weighing up what she was going to say.

“Red… I don’t think that’s the case for you.”

He looked up at the screen.

“Why do you say that?”

BGM: ‘Don’t Leave Me’ 01:14–02:04

“Your Charizard shows that you’re capable of facing whatever needs to be faced. And your Pikachu… proves that you’ll never become someone like them. Even if you become the strongest. Even if you win the title.”

She paused.

“But you’re right about one thing. If Green were to take that throne, he wouldn’t remain much different from Giovanni for long. Someone has to stop him. It’s just… if the world were really to be turned upside down because of him, and you chose to leave… I wouldn’t hold it against you.”

Red looked at her intently through the screen.

“Why?”

Misty turned her face away slightly.

“Because I’m not even sure that would be enough. And because… I’d rather stay with the people who matter to me. It’s a form of selfishness, too.”

Red understood. He didn’t press the issue.

A longer silence fell. Then, almost in spite of himself:

“Come to think of it… I bet Blue kept an eye on me for a bit. Was that your idea?”

Misty flinched in surprise. A faint blush crept up her cheeks.

“Where did you get that from?”

“Just a hunch. Her heart’s already taken. It must have been hard for her.”

He hesitated for another moment.

“But I must admit… I would have preferred it to be you who came with me.”

Misty blinked.

“What do you mean…?”

“In Cerulean… the thought of staying longer crossed my mind. Not just in passing. I really meant it.”

He spoke with an almost fearless awkwardness, as if he no longer had the strength to beat about the bush.

“It was just a thought,” he finally added. “But it was enough to show me how I felt.”

Misty did not confirm anything. Nor did she deny anything. She simply stood there, somewhat frozen, perhaps taking advantage of the distance the screen put between them.

Red looked down.

“I just hope… that the Elite Four will be able to stop Green. So that I don’t have to do it myself.”

The screen continued to crackle faintly. Neither of them ended the call straight away.

End of scene

Scene – The Incubus's Realisation

Lance's room at the Pokémon League. Daylight, following Lance's defeat

The room was unadorned. Light-coloured walls, functional furniture, a large window opening out onto the League's gardens. The light fell evenly across the room, without any warmth.

Red stood facing Lance. His breathing had not yet fully returned to normal after the battle. He stood upright, his arms at his sides.

Lance looked at him for a moment, then spoke in a calm voice:

"You are now the Pokémon League Champion."

A very slight softening crossed Red's gaze. It faded almost immediately. He looked down briefly, then looked up again. His fingers clenched weakly against his palms.

Lance continued, in a lower tone:

"Well… not quite."

Red didn't move. Only his jaw tensed slightly. His gaze shifted for a moment to some undefined point behind Lance, as if he needed a second to let the information sink in. His breathing, which had almost returned to normal, became more controlled, more shallow.

'There is still one more trial ahead of you,' said Lance. 'A great Trainer awaits you. His name is Green. He defeated the Council of Four before you did.'

BGM 'Powerful Predatory Deadly' 03:08–the end

The silence that followed was stark.

Red remained motionless. His shoulders did not slump. Yet something hardened in his expression. A very slight tension appeared at the corners of his eyes. His fingers clenched tighter, until they turned slightly white.

He did not reply.

The information had sunk in with brutal precision. What he had hoped for — that the Elite Four might still be able to contain Green — had just come crashing down. The nightmare he had conjured up the day before, almost in spite of himself, was taking shape. There was no turning back now.

Lance stood facing him, his hands clasped, making no attempt to soften the blow. But the camera did not linger on him.

It remained on Red.

On the way his gaze had been drained of all relief. On the subtle tension in his hands. On the silence with which he met the news, not out of defiance, but because he had nothing left to say.

He finally nodded very slowly, just once.

Then he stood there, upright, already elsewhere.

End of scene

Scene – The Extinction of Courage

Room at the League

BGM ‘Powerful Predatory Deadly’ 01:21–02:21

The Room was larger than in ordinary battles. The authorised spectators—Oak, Blue, the Elite Four—stood back, behind the safety line. The air smelled of residual electricity and stirred-up dust.

On the battlefield, Pikachu crouched low, its cheeks already puffed out. Opposite it, Blastoise had barely moved for several rounds. The official display clearly showed its remaining HP: between sixty and seventy per cent.

Red raised his hand.

A Thunderbolt attack. The bolt shot out sharply, violently, and struck Blastoise’s shell with full force. A brief crackle. Sparks slid down the cannons. Then nothing. Blastoise didn’t flinch. The figure on the display barely dropped.

Red stared at the screen for a fraction of a second too long. His disappointment was barely visible on his face. Just a stillness that was a little too perfect.

Green made a barely perceptible gesture.

Blastoise opened its cannons. The Hydro Pump fired without fanfare, heavy and direct. The jet struck Pikachu head-on. The little body was hurled backwards and crashed to the ground, motionless.

BGM ‘Powerful Predatory Deadly’ 02:05–02:21

The silence was brief.

Red had already raised his hand. The ball shot out, engulfed Pikachu, and returned to his palm with a dull thud. The movement was clean, almost mechanical. As if he refused to let defeat take hold for a single second longer.

He remained standing, the ball still warm against his fingers.

Then his free hand reached for the last one.

Charizard.

BGM ‘Fire It Is’ 01:40–end

The moment his fingers touched the cold surface of the Poké Ball, something stirred within him. Not a clear image. Rather, a sudden, confused pressure: Route 22, the previous recall, the weight of what was expected of a ‘true’ winner, the feeling of having already betrayed something essential without being able to put a name to it. All of it welled up in one go, in no particular order, and weighed heavily upon his chest.

He didn’t buckle. His shoulders remained straight. But at the corners of his eyes, a glisten of moisture appeared, too faint to be noticed from a distance. His breathing became very shallow, very controlled. For a second, he no longer really envisaged what came next. Only the heavy realisation that perhaps it had all been in vain.

He was still capable of carrying on. But he was no longer sure why.

The end of the BGM ‘Fire It Is’

‘Red!’

The voice cut through the air.

Red blinked. The spiral broke. He turned his head slightly, searching for the source.

Blue was standing amongst the spectators. Her face was stern, showing no apparent gentleness. Only a serious, steadfast, almost harsh expression. She wasn’t smiling. She wasn’t reaching out her hand. She had simply called him back, by name, with enough force to bring him round.

Red looked at her for a second.

Then he clenched his fingers around Charizard’s Poké Ball.

End of scene

Scene – Paradoxical Encouragement

Room at the League

Background music: ‘EP06 S02 00:30–01:50’

The silence that had followed Blue’s call had not yet had time to dissipate. All eyes were already fixed on her. Red, for his part, remained as if suspended, his face still bewildered, out of the loop.

Blue did not look away.

She stood there for a second longer, her gaze fixed on him with a steadfastness that no one could quite interpret. Then she spoke, in a clear voice, without raising her tone:

‘Don’t forget your connection to Water.’

The words rang out clearly in the hall.

She said nothing more. Without hurrying, she returned to her seat, her back straight, her hands resting on her knees. Her face had regained an apparent composure. Only a very slight tension in her shoulders, and the fact that she was barely blinking, betrayed the cost of what she had just done.

Red stared at her. At first, he didn’t understand. Then, bit by bit, the realisation dawned on him. Water. Not her. Something else. Someone else.

All around them, the atmosphere remained heavy with tension. People had heard. People had seen. The connections would soon be made, inevitably.

Green, on the other side of the pitch, had not moved. His expression remained impassive, almost icy. Yet something had shifted. A barely perceptible tightening at the corner of his mouth, a glance that lingered a fraction of a second too long on Blue before returning to Red. He composed himself at once. Neutrality returned, but it was no longer quite intact.

Blue could already feel the consequences setting in. The misunderstandings. The misinterpretations. The foolish jealousy that was bound to arise. She had foreseen them. She accepted them. That didn't stop her from being overwhelmed by them. A subtle, muffled sense of shame tightened around her chest. She didn't even know if that gesture would actually help. Yet she'd done it anyway. Because she couldn't let Red sink into despair alone, and because she knew that, in the state he was in, he wouldn't have rediscovered that connection on his own.

BGM 'EP06 S02 00:30–01:50' 01:13–the end

Red, for his part, suddenly felt a warmth rising in his chest. It had not appeared out of nowhere. It was more as if his overwhelming despair had, until then, made it imperceptible. Now that he had moved slightly away from the edge, he could feel it again.

He stood motionless for a second. Then, almost without thinking, he slipped a hand inside his jacket, feeling around the fabric with a dazed precision, as if he were searching for something he needed to touch in order to believe it was there.

End of scene

Scene – Water, Fire, the World

Room at the League, in a dreamlike atmosphere

BGM 'Maria Renard'

Red plunged his hand further into his jacket. His fingers came across a small metal object, cold to the touch. He pulled it out.

Misty's badge.

He looked at it for a moment, as if recognition were slow in coming. Then it all clicked into place at once. The foolishness of what had gone through his mind just seconds earlier dawned on him with almost painful clarity. He closed his eyes and pressed the badge against his chest, just above his heart.

An older warmth welled up within him.

It wasn't a revelation. It was more like the return of a presence he'd never really lost, but which he'd stopped listening to. As if someone had remained there, in the background, simply waiting for him to allow himself to feel them again.

Behind his eyelids, shapes took on form, though not clearly defined. Silhouettes in the half-light: ordinary trainers he'd once met on the roads, a Hiker, a Gentleman, and others besides. Their faces were not clearly distinguishable, but something about their demeanour came through nonetheless—a quiet kindness, a limited clarity, precious precisely because it did not pretend to be more than it

was. And amongst them, closer still, the silhouette of Misty, she too bathed in that same imperfect light.

The flame within him did not die out upon contact with the water. It became more defined. It lost some of its raw intensity and gained in steadiness. It no longer sought merely to consume; it illuminated, it endured.

Red realised then, without saying much, that this love would not protect him from everything. Love offered no shelter from anything, really. It would not make the struggles any less gruelling, nor the choices any less costly. But it created a modest refuge, an anchor firm enough to prevent him from drifting away entirely. A discreet bridge to the world. Nothing more. And that was already a great deal.

He opened his eyes again.

BGM 'Maria Renard' 01:14–end

The League Hall was still there. The stands, the Elite Four, Green, Blue, Professor Oak. Nothing had changed on the surface. Yet something within him had settled.

A sober, almost rare contentment settled within him. There was nothing exalted about it. It was a residual bliss, simple, yet real. He recognised it. And, in the same breath, he admitted without hesitation what he was feeling.

He was in love.

Red clutched the badge for another second, then eased his grip slightly. He was no longer clutching it as if clinging on. He now held it with a sort of discreet, almost gentle gratitude, simply happy that this happiness had been bestowed upon him.

End of scene

Scene – The Fate of Being the Strongest

Room at the League

Red turned his head slightly towards the stands. His gaze met Blue's for a fraction of a second. The expression he directed at her was minimal—barely a softening around his eyes—but it was enough. Blue understood. Some of the tension she had been carrying since her intervention eased imperceptibly.

Red looked down at the Poké Ball in his hand. He murmured a few words, quietly enough that only he and Charizard could hear them. The Poké Ball vibrated faintly in response. Then he threw it.

The Recall Light opened. Charizard appeared on the field with a short, controlled flap of his wings. He did not roar. He merely stared at Blastoise, his eyes narrowed, already in position.

Green lifted his chin slightly. A faint, almost incredulous smile touched his lips.

'How unusual,' he said. 'You're no longer trying to get round it.'

Red did not look away.

“Yes…” He paused very briefly. “If one of the two most dangerous beings has to disappear… what difference does it really make?”

His tone was flat, tinged with a hint of sarcasm that was not really meant to hurt. Green barely furrowed his brow, as if he still could not quite grasp the angle Red was taking.

Red continued, more quietly, but clearly enough for the whole room to hear:

“We both have the same badge. The one we got from the leader of Team Rocket.”

BGM ‘Rebellion’ 00:32–00:59

A distinct silence fell over the hall. Someone in the stands could be heard holding their breath. Agatha turned her head slightly towards Lorelei. Bruno remained motionless. Oak, for his part, didn’t move, but his fingers closed very slowly around the armrest. Blue remained perfectly still.

Red continued, without raising his voice:

‘With this badge, we can force any of our Pokémon into absolute obedience. For a while, Silph Co. was overrun. They wanted the Master Ball… to control the strongest of all Pokémon. I don’t even know which one it was. But at the end of the road… you end up like Giovanni.’

He lowered his eyes to the floor for a moment, then looked back up at Green.

“How ironic. This badge bears your colour. You chose Squirtle instead of Bulbasaur… Logically, you would have avoided this path. But it seems you can’t change that sort of thing so easily. I’m truly sorry.”

Green almost burst out in a short, joyless laugh.

“Oh… are you going to give me a lecture now? That I don’t love my Pokémon enough? That with great power comes great responsibility?”

His voice was mocking, weary. He was not really attacking Oak or the Elite Four; he was simply fed up in advance with what he thought he recognised: yet another classic moral lecture.

He had not yet realised that Red was not lecturing him.

He was opening up something far darker to him.

End of scene

Scene – The Prisoner of the Locked World

Room at the League

Red did not look up straight away. When he spoke, his voice was low, almost even.

“You are imprisoned in a closed world.”

BGM ‘Vampire Messiah’ 00:00–00:44

Green blinked once. The statement had been a far cry from what he’d expected. Red continued, unhurriedly:

“A world that seems perfect. But empty. Closed off. And one that hardly evolves any more.”

A silence stretched out. Up in the stands, Lance didn’t move. Blue, for her part, had straightened her back slightly. Oak was staring at Red with a sudden, keener focus.

Green finally asked, his voice hoarser:

“What exactly are you getting at?”

Red finally looked at him.

“You’re talented. You’re putting in real effort. You’re not bad by nature. But your privilege blinds you. You’re the grandson of the most respected trainer. You’ve had access to the data, the research, his mentoring. You’ve had almost everything the best had to offer… sometimes more than I did. It’s only natural that you’re strong. Even the strongest. The one I feared. But you’ve become the king of a monopoly. Of a technocracy. It’s a form of perfection. Frozen. Stagnant.”

Charizard shifted his weight from one leg to the other. Blastoise, standing opposite him, remained motionless, but his eyes had narrowed slightly.

Red continued, more slowly:

BGM: ‘Dido’s Lament’

“You hardly invent anything anymore. You optimise. You refine. You exploit what already exists. It’s as if revolutionaries had overthrown the old aristocracy… and their descendants had become the new one.”

Oak made an almost imperceptible movement. The colour had drained from his face. He understood, all at once, why he’d never managed to get through to Green in that way. Something within him had always recoiled from that diagnosis.

Blue, for her part, felt a sense of awe and fear welling up within her. She could now see what she’d failed to see for years, precisely because she’d grown up too close to Green. The dogmas within which one lives for a long time eventually obscure certain truths. A cold sense of contrition gripped her chest.

Red continued, sparing her no mercy:

‘You’re not entirely cruel. But you push aside whatever doesn’t serve you. Feelings, pain… you ignore them, except when they become useful. You don’t truly accept the other ways trainers live, because they prevent them from becoming stronger. The truth is, you’re so privileged that you can’t even see them anymore. And you’ve been exempt from it.’

He lowered his eyes for a moment, as if judging himself.

“Science and research don’t create anything on their own. They exist because ordinary people, with few resources, face up to their difficulties. That’s why the data you possess isn’t something you’re entitled to.”

A series of fleeting images flashed through his mind: a Hiker, a Gentleman, other figures he’d encountered along the way. Not heroes. Just ordinary people, with their modest wisdom and clear-sighted kindness.

“Even weak, insignificant profiles develop wisdom in their own way. If they do so with clear-sighted kindness, they make the world a better place. The strong benefit from it. That’s why power comes with responsibility. I don’t know if I’m stronger than you. But I recognised myself in those people. I drew strength from them. That’s probably why I’ve been able to beat you… so far.”

Green shook his head slightly. For the first time, his voice lost some of its mocking tone.

“I do not envy you, Red. Your performance amazes me. But I still do not understand. I am better equipped than my grandfather was. I have put in the effort. So why is victory not mine?”

BGM: ‘Dido’s Lament’ 01:21–end

Red replied without beating about the bush, and this time the melancholy was clearly evident in his voice:

“Because the Professor’s true legacies… are curiosity, discovery, and courage.”

Oak closed his eyes briefly. When he opened them again, tears had already welled up at the corners. It was not pride. It was remorse. A child whom he had, in a way, driven towards misfortune, had just paid him the only compliment that truly mattered — and the contrast almost hurt him.

Red added, more quietly:

‘It’s not your fault. But things like that aren’t easily passed on like an inheritance.’

He paused.

“This world isn’t perfect. But it hasn’t become any worse… because the Professor has preserved it.”

Oak could no longer hold back his tears. They now flowed freely, silently.

Red then uttered the final sentence, almost as if it carried no weight at all:

‘At Silph Co., if the young Professor had been there… he would have faced Team Rocket without a moment’s hesitation. He would have protected anyone. Defended whatever needed defending. Whether he was Champion or not.’

Green felt those words strike him right in the chest. He heard them as an unwitting reproach, and all the more unassailable for it. The contrast was too stark. He could find nothing to say in reply.

The silence that followed was heavier than any that had come before.

End of scene

Scene – Pragmatic Respect

Room at the League

BGM ‘Don’t Listen to Her’ 01:04–around 02:04

Green was the first to break the silence. His voice had regained a hint of mockery, but it sounded more worn than before.

‘Speaking of which… will your sermon be enough to convert me?’

Red replied bluntly, in a tone that was confident, though still slightly unsteady:

“No. Disenchanting you by winning would be enough for me.”

Green raised an eyebrow.

‘Oh… and you’re claiming you’re going to win?’

Red did not smile.

“I’m containing you. Simply for fear that you might become a threat to those I care about. That’s enough.”

The words came out with an almost bureaucratic dryness. Green did not reply straight away. Something about this dismissal—being treated not as a rival, nor even as a worthy enemy, but as a potential threat to be contained—caused him a discomfort he had not experienced before. He clenched his jaw slightly and looked away ever so slightly, as if to prevent the effect from being too obvious.

Red lowered his gaze for a moment. When he spoke again, his voice had lost some of its sharpness. It had become more hesitant, almost awkward.

‘Green… you’re still corrigible. I wish I could say that I’m doing my utmost to save you… because I regard you as my brother. But I can’t.’

He paused very briefly, as if still weighing up his words.

“Simplistic methods don’t really work anymore. Not in this day and age. A chilling, pragmatic foundation… that may be the only form of genuine respect I can offer you now.”

The silence that followed grew noticeably thicker. Charizard took a step forward, slow, almost solemn. Blastoise didn’t move, but his eyes had narrowed.

Up in the stands, Blue remained perfectly still. Oak’s face was impassive. Lance watched the two Trainers without blinking, as if he were already gauging the distance that still lay between words and battle.

Red finally looked up. So did Green.

There was little more to be said.

End of scene

Scene – The costly and hollow battle – Don’t Listen to Her

BGM ‘Don’t Listen to Her’ from 02:04

The two Trainers took up their positions without a word. Green on the left, Red on the right. Blastoise and Charizard faced each other in the centre of the arena, the space between them already charged with tension.

BGM ‘Don’t Listen to Her’ from 02:18

Green raised his hand. The movement was slow, almost mechanical, yet executed with absolute precision. Blastoise understood immediately. It raised the barrel of its shell towards the ceiling.

A moderate downpour fell upon the pitch. Not a storm. A precise, calculated rain that soaked the ground without touching the stands. The air changed in density. Charizard's flames lost some of their brilliance.

Red barely moved. Only a slight clenching of his jaw betrayed his instinctive alarm. Charizard flapped its wings once, lower down, already adjusting its stance.

Blastoise opened its mouth. A dense Water Pulse shot straight towards Charizard. Charizard swerved aside with a sideways flap and, in the same movement, fired a Dragon Pulse that met the water stream mid-air. The two attacks cancelled each other out with a muffled whoosh.

The pattern repeated itself. Water Pulse. Dodge. Dragon Pulse. Again. Charizard was not trying to advance. It was neutralising the threat.

Then Green clenched his fist slightly. Blastoise charged a Hydro Pump. The water surged forth with far greater force, amplified by the rain.

BGM 'Don't Listen to Her' from around 02:42

Charizard rolled onto its side. The attack whizzed past its flank. A second Hydro Pump followed immediately, more relentless, aiming to pin it against the edge. Charizard had no choice but to brace itself against the arena wall. A claw gripped the surface, its body pivoted with almost superhuman precision, and it propelled itself out of the path at the very last moment. The water crashed against the wall with a thud.

Green watched. He thought he understood. Red was trying to use up the PP.

He made a more obvious, almost blatant move. Blastoise summoned a Blizzard. The cold swept across the field, seeking to deprive Charizard of any cover from above.

Charizard did not even attempt to dodge it head-on. A short, precise burst of flame sliced through the heart of the Blizzard. The ice shattered into shards that rained down in a secondary shower.

BGM 'Don't Listen to Her' from around 03:08

The Rain Dance downpour gradually subsided; the rain slowly ceased. A heavy dampness remained, a strange, almost cryptic veil suspended in the air. The atmosphere had changed; something unreal had taken hold.

In the stands, no one spoke. Blue's hands were clasped too tightly. Oak had stopped blinking. Lance followed every movement with icy attention.

Blastoise and Green then sensed something amiss. Too late.

BGM 'Don't Listen to Her' from around 03:32

A ring of fire, coming from a blind spot on a low, curved trajectory, had already closed in around Blastoise. **Fire Spin**. The power was not overwhelming, yet it was persistent. It clung to its legs and the underside of its shell, preventing any clear concentration. Another Rain Dance was now impossible for the time being.

Charizard did not wait. He fired a precise Flamethrower, slightly off-centre, as if he were still gauging his aim. The attack hit, but with calculated restraint. He cast an extremely brief glance at the arena screen, checking Blastoise's remaining HP. Then he fired a second Flamethrower, even more ruthless in its power.

Blastoise, cornered, attempted one last head-on Hydro Pump.

Charizard first dodged it with an almost insulting ease. Then, in a clearly deliberate move, he altered his trajectory and stepped into the attack's remaining range.

Blastoise instinctively recoiled. Green's eyes widened slightly. They'd both seen it: it wasn't a mistake. Charizard had just chosen to put himself in harm's way.

BGM 'Don't Listen to Her' from around 03:58

The water struck him with full force. Charizard was hurled backwards, a hoarse cry escaping him. Deep-water burns marked his flank and part of his wing. Yet he remained conscious, perfectly lucid.

And then the flame on its tail changed. It flared up abruptly, almost violently, shifting from a deep orange to an unstable red-white. Blaze had just been activated.

Charizard steadied himself in the air. He was now advancing.

Red, for the first time since the fight began, clenched the fingers of one hand. A subtle gesture. A sign of agreement.

BGM 'Don't Listen to Her' from around 04:12

Charizard closed the gap. At the exact range where Blastoise had no room to manoeuvre, it opened its mouth.

Blast Burn.

The explosion was almost total. The flame engulfed Blastoise in one go, so dense that its shell could no longer be made out for several long seconds, and Blastoise's Hydro Pump was halted.

BGM 'Don't Listen to Her' from around 04:21

Charizard did not ease off. He kept the power at almost maximum, as if refusing to settle for anything less than full force. The flames surrounding him grew even more intense.

Then the fire went out in an instant.

Blastoise remained standing for a fraction of a second longer, swaying. Then its legs gave way. It collapsed heavily onto the sodden ground.

The silence that followed was far from a cheer. It was a silence of deference.

Red did not raise his arms. Charizard landed heavily, his slightly injured wing outstretched, the flame on his tail still too bright, as if he did not yet know how to bring it down.

Victory was there. Bitter. Almost dishonourable.

End of scene

Scene – Victory, devoid of elation

BGM: 'Somewhere Safe'

The silence that followed Blastoise's fall was not a silence of admiration. It was a silence of realisation.

Charizard was still standing, but his breathing had become heavy and irregular. The flame on his tail, which had been blazing high just moments earlier, had returned to its usual size, looking almost weary. He was no longer looking at anyone. Something within him seemed to have withdrawn, as if he had just carried out an act he would never wish to repeat.

Red, for his part, had not moved. He remained facing the empty space where Blastoise had just collapsed. The pressure he had held in throughout the battle suddenly turned against him. His shoulders slumped slightly. He had won. And yet he felt as though he had seized a shapeless, hollow, burdensome throne – something he had never desired. Even knowing that Green was wrong, a part of him couldn't help thinking that this seat should have remained beyond his reach. That he had usurped it.

Tears welled up in his eyes, restrained, almost discreet. They flowed without a sob, simply because his remorse had finally overflowed.

No one in the stands dared to break the silence. They had witnessed the mastery. They had witnessed the valour. But no one felt inclined to cross the line to offer congratulations.

Green was taking a while to take in what he was seeing. His gaze shifted from Blastoise to Red, then back again, as if the image refused to settle. He wasn't rejecting what he saw. He simply couldn't process it. Too many things had just changed in too short a space of time.

Without a word, he recalled Blastoise. The gesture was discreet, almost invisible to anyone familiar with the old tales. The Poké Ball closed silently.

Then Green gathered what composure he had left and spoke. His voice was low, devoid of any mockery.

'Red… I know you're right. But there's too much, all of a sudden… that's beyond my comprehension. I'm sorry I can't take it all in straight away.'

There was shame in his words, and a genuine sense of contrition. He knew he was in the wrong. But he was unable to shoulder the full weight of the consequences, nor to atone for them in any meaningful way. Not now.

He turned away and walked towards the exit.

Before he had crossed the threshold, Blue caught sight of the glint of his tears. A wave of bitterness welled up in her heart. She instinctively realised that going to him at that moment – acting too motherly, too intrusive – would only have hurt him further. She stayed where she was.

Red and Charizard remained in the centre of the pitch, each lost in their own weariness. Lance watched from the stands, his expression unreadable, without intervening.

Blue then turned towards Oak. The Professor had not moved, yet something in his demeanour had shifted. His tone, his posture, the way he avoided looking at the pitch… everything had become disjointed, as if he had just succumbed to a remorse that was too old and too specific.

‘Is everything all right… Professor? Aren’t you going to congratulate Red…?’

Oak did not look up.

“I can’t bring myself to…”

His voice was low. Blue sensed immediately that this was no longer merely a matter of tiredness or sadness. A sense of foreboding washed over her.

“What is troubling you so much…?”

BGM: ‘Somewhere Safe’ 01:14–the end

Oak remained silent for a moment. Then, still without looking at her, he murmured, just loud enough for her alone to hear:

“The Old Man Coyote… is real…”

Blue felt a chill run down the back of her neck. She did not fully understand the meaning of those words. But she realised that something macabre had just been named, and that it should not be dismissed lightly.

In a corner of the room, almost out of sight, a shadow lingered. It didn’t need to reveal itself fully. Its smile—at once repulsive and impassive—said enough: it had seen everything, right from the start. Patient. Scrutinising. Ancient. It hadn’t come to intervene. Only to confirm that everything was unfolding as planned.

End of scene

Scene – Route 22

BGM ‘EP03 S01 23:04–24:17’

Route 22 stretched out beneath a sky that was already low. Twilight had begun to drain the colours from the landscape. The grass along the roadside was turning grey. A light breeze occasionally stirred up the dust.

Giovanni stood there, dressed for travel. Before him, a red-haired boy had just collapsed to his knees. The fight had lasted only as long as was necessary. The disparity had been absolute.

The boy knew. He had anticipated defeat. He had not come out of naivety. He had come to preserve something — a remnant, a trace, an impossible recognition. Now that it was all over, the words would no longer come. Only tears took their place. They flowed silently, heavily, as if carrying away what he had failed to hold on to.

Giovanni stared at him intently. His gaze was unyielding, almost cold-blooded. There was no restraint in him born of childhood, no semblance of politeness, no regard for blood ties. The family connection seemed not to exist. Or rather: it mattered not a jot.

He turned away with fluid grace. Without a word. Without a glance back.

His footsteps faded along the road. Soon his figure disappeared round the first bend.

The boy remained on his knees. Even when Giovanni was out of sight, the tears did not stop. He was weeping over an injustice he could not name, an abandonment that had already taken place. He had no support left. He had nothing left.

Twilight continued to deepen on Route 22.

End of episode

Close of episode

Totals — present compilation

Scenes: 21

Words (extract): ≈ 12,300

Silent reading: ≈ 60 min · read aloud: ≈ 80 min

Same finding as episode 01: an arc compilation rather than a 22–28 min episode. Possible split: Kanto roads / League + Route 22.

P1 notices still open

Café / Lingerie (header). Camp Boy: “What are we doing? Shouldn’t we go over to her?” Unlabelled speakers. contain (not hold back); corrigible; contaminating tears; what it implied (the remark). Red-haired boy unnamed. Blaze note removed from the body (done here). Blue: her, not his.

Version notes

2026-09-23 — EN-GB apparatus after P1. Parallel to episode 01. Index split pieces / traces. Technical notes isolated. Author filled to match episodes 03–04.

Open for what follows

The Old Man Coyote is real · Green saturated · green badge · Silver on his knees · Johto still waiting.

BGM credits

Pieces and traces: Castlevania: Nocturne (Netflix), except Lacrimosa (Mozart, Édouard’s version in Nocturne). Span detail: index above.